



Types of shellfish

Gastropod



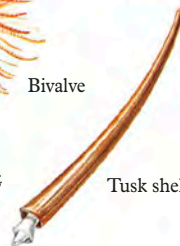
Chiton



Bivalve



Tusk shell



Tentacles feeling for plankton

Giant clam

The biggest shellfish in the world is the giant clam. This huge bivalve lives in warm waters and is more than three feet (one meter) wide. You could easily fit inside its two big shells, but you wouldn't get trapped. Giant clams can only close their shells very slowly, giving you plenty of time to escape.



Big foot

The soft, brightly colored skin on this fingerprint flamingo tongue shellfish is called a mantle. It can wrap right around the shell. As it slides over the shell, it smooths away scratches on the surface.

White shell



Coral suckers

These two bellybutton cowries are using their rough tongues to pull out tiny coral animals. Other shellfish eat seaweed and even fish!

When it is frightened, this shellfish will hide inside its shell. Some shellfish do not need to hide—cone shells can kill people by injecting them with poison!

This cowrie's mantle is spotted like the coral it is sitting on. This helps hide it from hungry starfish.

Spotted foot

Coral

